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✦ AI Overview



To access macOS Recovery, shut down your Mac completely. Then, restart by holding the power button (Apple Silicon) or using the **Command (⌘) + R** keyboard shortcut (Intel). This mode lets you reinstall macOS, restore from Time Machine, use Disk Utility to erase your drive, and change security settings. 🍏 Apple Support +1

Mac with Apple Silicon

Use these steps if you have an M1, M2, M3, or newer Apple Silicon MacBook.

1. **Shut down:** Choose the Apple menu  and click **Shut Down**. Wait for your screen to go completely dark.
2. **Access Startup Options:** Press and hold the **power button** (or Touch ID).
3. **Select Options:** Continue holding until "Loading startup options" appears on the screen. Click the **Options** (gear) icon, then click **Continue**.
4. **Log in:** Select an administrator user account, click **Next**, and enter the account password. 🍏 Apple Support +3

For a visual guide on booting an Apple Silicon (M1/M2/M3) Mac into recovery mode:

How to Boot Mac M1, M2 & M3 in Recovery Mode Step by Step Guide



Documee
YouTube · Sep 9, 2025



Intel-based Mac

Use these steps if you have an older Intel-based MacBook. 🍏 Apple Support +1

1. **Shut down:** Choose the Apple menu  and click **Shut Down**. Wait for your screen to turn off.
2. **Power on & Hold keys:** Press and immediately release the power button, then press and hold the **Command (⌘) and R** keys on your keyboard.
3. **Wait for loading:** Continue holding the keys until you see the Apple logo, a spinning globe, or a loading bar.

globe, or a loading bar.

4. **Log in:** Select a user, click **Next**, and enter your password.  Apple Support

To see the exact timing for pressing and holding keys on an Intel-based Mac:

How to get into recovery mode on an intel mac.

 Random Nugs
YouTube · Nov 18, 2023



Recovery Mode Options (Utilities)

Once booted successfully into macOS Recovery, you will be prompted with a window offering several key utilities:  Apple Support

- **Restore from Time Machine:** Reverts your system to a previous state from an external backup drive.
- **Reinstall macOS:** Downloads and installs the clean version of the macOS operating system.
- **Disk Utility:** Allows you to format, erase, or run First Aid on your startup disk (e.g., Macintosh HD).
- **Terminal:** Gives advanced users access to the command line.  Apple Support +1

Note: If you have an Intel Mac and are trying to factory reset or upgrade, you can also use `Option + Command + R` or `Shift + Option + Command + R` to boot into Internet Recovery and pull a different version of macOS.  Apple Support +1

Full details and network troubleshooting guides can be found on the [Apple Support Guide](#).

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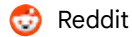
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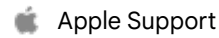
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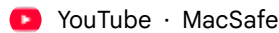
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How to Boot into Recovery Mode - Mac

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2:52

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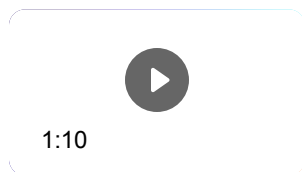
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Learn how to start macOS **Recovery** on both **Apple** Silicon and Intel-based Macs to reinstall macOS, **restore** from backup, and more.

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Shut down your Intel **Mac**, hold Command + R while pressing the power button, select your account, and enter your password to enter **recovery mode**.

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1:17

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